Alex Rivera

Software Engineer — Full Stack & Cloud Systems

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1. Introduction / Professional Profile

I am a results-driven Software Engineer with over 7 years of experience designing, building, and shipping scalable web applications and distributed backend systems. My career has spanned early-stage startups and mid-size product companies, where I have owned features end-to-end — from requirements and architecture through implementation, testing, deployment, and production support.

I specialize in modern TypeScript/JavaScript stacks, cloud-native services on AWS, and clean API design. I enjoy mentoring junior engineers, improving developer experience, and turning ambiguous product goals into reliable software that users trust.

2. Professional Summary

Proven track record delivering customer-facing platforms serving 100K+ monthly active users with high availability targets (99.9%+). Strong background in React, Next.js, Node.js, .NET, PostgreSQL, Redis, and CI/CD automation. Comfortable leading technical design reviews, writing RFCs, and collaborating with product, design, and QA.

Looking for a Software Engineer role focused on product impact, engineering excellence, and continuous learning.

3. Contact Information

- **Full Name:** Alex Rivera
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- **Location:** San Francisco, CA, USA
- **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com/in/alexrivera-swe
- **Portfolio / Website:** alexrivera.dev
- **Availability:** Open to full-time opportunities

4. Education Details

B.S. in Computer Science — University of California, Berkeley

2013 – 2017 | GPA: 3.72 / 4.00 | Berkeley, CA

- Coursework: Algorithms, Operating Systems, Databases, Distributed Systems, Machine Learning basics
- Senior Capstone: Real-time collaborative document editor (WebSockets + CRDTs)
- Teaching Assistant for Introduction to Data Structures (2 semesters)

Online Specialization — Cloud Architecture — Coursera / Google Cloud

2021 | GPA: Completed with distinction | Remote

- Covered GKE, Cloud Run, Pub/Sub, IAM, and cost-aware design patterns
- Capstone: Multi-service e-commerce demo with autoscaling and observability

5. Core Skills

Technical Skills

- Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, Python, SQL, HTML/CSS
- Frontend: React, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, accessibility (a11y) practices
- Backend: Node.js/Express, ASP.NET Core Web API, REST, GraphQL basics
- Data: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch basics
- Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS), Docker, GitHub Actions, Terraform basics
- Testing: Jest, Playwright, xUnit, integration and contract testing mindset

Tools & Platforms

- Git, GitHub, Jira, Linear, Figma (handoff), Postman, Swagger/OpenAPI
- Datadog, Sentry, CloudWatch for monitoring and incident triage
- VS Code, Visual Studio 2022, Cursor

Soft Skills

- Clear written communication (RFCs, PR descriptions, runbooks)
- Cross-functional collaboration with Product and Design
- Mentorship, code review hygiene, and pragmatic prioritization

6. Certifications & Training

- AWS Certified Developer – Associate (2022)
- Scrum Foundation awareness (team delivery practices)
- Internal security training: OWASP Top 10 and secure coding checklist

7. Additional Qualifications

I regularly contribute to internal engineering blogs covering incident retrospectives and performance tuning. I have also presented lunch-and-learns on Next.js App Router migration and API versioning strategies.

Open to hybrid or remote roles with occasional on-site collaboration. Prefer environments that value automated testing, thoughtful code review, and measurable product outcomes.

8. Projects

ResumeMatch AI — Resume Ranking Web App

Full Stack Engineer (personal / portfolio) | 2025 – 2026

Built a simple Next.js + .NET Web API app that uploads resumes and uses Google Gemini to rank them against a job description.

- Implemented file upload (max 3 resumes), PDF text extraction, and Gemini prompt pipeline
- Designed a minimal 4-section UI: upload, list, job description, best-match result
- Focused on simple architecture: one controller, one Gemini service with small helper functions

PulseBoard — Real-time Ops Dashboard

Lead Frontend + API integration | 2023 – 2024

Internal dashboard for operations teams to monitor order pipelines and alert thresholds.

- React + WebSocket feed with optimistic UI updates and reconnect strategy
- Reduced mean time to notice (MTTN) for pipeline stalls by ~35%
- Added role-based views for managers vs on-call engineers

ShopLite Checkout Service

Backend Engineer | 2022

Stateless checkout microservice with idempotent payment intents and webhook reconciliation.

- Designed idempotency keys and outbox pattern for reliable event publishing
- Load-tested to 500 RPS with p95 latency under 120ms for read paths
- Wrote runbooks and chaos test checklist for payment provider outages

DocuSync Collaborative Notes

University Capstone / Maintainer | 2017

Browser-based collaborative notes with conflict-free replicated data types.

- Implemented CRDT merge logic and presence indicators
- Packaged demo with Docker Compose for local multi-user testing

9. Professional Experience (Detailed)

Senior Software Engineer — Northline Systems

Jan 2022 – Present | San Francisco, CA (Hybrid)

Own customer account and billing surfaces for a B2B SaaS platform. Partner with product managers to ship quarterly roadmap items and keep production healthy.

- Led migration of legacy jQuery admin pages to Next.js + TypeScript, improving Lighthouse performance scores from ~55 to ~90
- Designed and shipped subscription upgrade/downgrade API with prorated billing edge cases covered by automated tests
- Introduced feature flags and canary releases; cut rollback time during incidents from hours to minutes
- Mentored 2 junior engineers; established PR checklist covering security, accessibility, and observability
- Participated in on-call rotation; authored postmortems with actionable follow-ups

Software Engineer — BrightCart Commerce

Aug 2018 – Dec 2021 | Oakland, CA

Built storefront and order APIs for a mid-market e-commerce platform used by independent retailers.

- Implemented cart and checkout flows with Node.js and PostgreSQL; reduced checkout abandonment by 8% after UX fixes
- Added Redis caching for catalog reads; lowered p95 catalog API latency by ~40%
- Collaborated with mobile team on shared OpenAPI contracts and contract tests
- Automated CI pipelines with lint, unit, and smoke tests on every pull request

Junior Software Engineer — HelioLabs Startup

Jun 2017 – Jul 2018 | San Jose, CA

Early-stage product engineer working across frontend and backend for an analytics MVP.

- Shipped MVP dashboard in React within first 3 months of joining
- Wrote ETL scripts in Python to ingest CSV exports from partner systems
- Set up basic monitoring and error reporting with Sentry

10. Extended Experience Highlights

Across roles I have repeatedly owned ambiguous problems: unclear requirements, legacy code, and production pressure. My approach is to clarify success metrics early, ship iteratively behind flags, and invest in tests where failure is expensive (payments, auth, data integrity).

I am comfortable pairing, running design reviews, and documenting decisions so teams can move faster later. Below are additional highlights not fully covered in the role bullets above.

- Reduced AWS compute spend ~18% by right-sizing services and scheduling non-prod environments
- Championed structured logging and correlation IDs across services for faster incident debugging
- Helped hire 4 engineers by writing take-home briefs and conducting system design interviews
- Volunteered as internal open-source champion for shared UI component library
- Completed security review remediation for SSO/SAML enterprise login path

11. Hobbies & Interests

Outside of work I stay curious and balanced through a mix of technical and creative hobbies.

- Building small open-source utilities and writing short engineering blog posts
- Weekend hiking in the Bay Area and amateur landscape photography
- Chess club meetups and solving algorithm puzzles for fun
- Cooking Mediterranean recipes and hosting friends for dinner
- Volunteering at local coding workshops for high school students

12. Closing Note

Thank you for reviewing my resume. I would welcome the chance to discuss how my software engineering background can help your team deliver reliable product outcomes. References available upon request.